MISSION BAY NEWS
Mobile Home Community

1971 *May 2025*

Monthly Newsletter

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PARK SECURITY

If you see anyone who looks like they do not belong in the park, especially at an odd hour, CALL 911 FIRST

The San Leandro Police has advised us to leave our front and back porch light on all night.
NON-EMERGENCY number for the police dept. is (510) 577-2740

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Mother's Day is on May 11

Mission Bay News Crew

Many thanks to our News Crew who organize and deliver our monthly magazine! You are appreciated!

Alice Leung	Coordinator
Brenda Gianni	Activity Calendar
Vince Crabill	Distribution
Michael Garris	1 thru 33 | 501 thru 541
James Gamble	50 thru 72 | 150 thru 197
Vince Crabill	101 thru 145
Marta Barnes	201 thru 239
Rosita Gee	250 thru 289
Nancy Garrett	301 thru 338
Irene Zhong	350 thru 387
Darrin McWilliams	401 thru 440
Angie Chan	450 thru 491

ACTIVITY CALENDAR

MAY 2025



SUN.	MON.	TUES.	WED.	THURS.	FRI.	SAT.
				1 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm)	2 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30	3 TAI CHI 10 – 11 M & W Cinco De Mayo 4 - 6
4	5 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 – 4 CINCO DE MAYO	6 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	7 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	8 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4 BOOK CLUB 1 pm (Crafts Rm)	9 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 RECYCLE	10 MBRA MTG 10 - 11
11 	12 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 – 4	13 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	14 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	15 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10-10:30 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm)	16 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 BIBLE STUDY 6:30 pm (Crafts Rm)	17 TAI CHI 10 – 11
18	19 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 – 4	20 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	21 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	22 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10-10:30 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30	23 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 RECYCLE	24 TAI CHI 10 – 11
25	26 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 LINE DANCING 3 – 4 	27 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	28 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	29 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10-10:30 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30	30 Aqua Aerobics 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30	31 TAI CHI 10 – 11

BIRTHDAYS & ANNIVERSARIES

MAY
Birthdays

Fidel Sanchez	May 2
Linda Woods	May 4
Kayan Wong	May 10
Benito Contrerras	May 16
Liz Griffiths	May 16
Rick Hibbs	May 18
Elizabeth Bowers	May 20
Raelena Anderson	May 21
Lois Silva	May 22
Amy Leung	May 25
Pui Ling Wong	May 25
Kristiana Brown	May 26
Terry Walsh	May 30

MAY
Anniversaries

Dick & Sandi Covell	May 3
John & Gail Faria	May 22



G S M O L
CHAPTER 518
J O I N U S

The Golden State Manufactured-Home Owners League (GSMOL) is a non-profit organization formed almost 60 years ago to protect the home values and quality of life of Mobile Home owners. In addition to working with the State of California and local legislatures, GSMOL works daily at the State level lobbying for legislation that will benefit Mobile Home owners. Through our Emergency Legal Fund (ELF), GSMOL pursues violations of the Mobilehome Residency Law (MRL798…) which protects Mobile Home owners.

To help GSMOL continue to provide these and other services,

we invite you to join today.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

GOLDEN STATE MANUFACTURED-HOME OWNERS LEAGUE, INC. 800-888-1727 714-826-4071 FAX : 714-994-9637

GSMOL
SERVING HOMEOWNERS SINCE 1962

- ☐ ONE-YEAR GSMOL MEMBERSHIP for $25
- ☐ ONE-YEAR SPOUSAL/PARTNER VOTING MEMBERSHIP for $10 more
- ☐ THREE-YEAR GSMOL MEMBERSHIP for $70
- ☐ ONE-YEAR *ASSOCIATE* MEMBERSHIP for $25

(Associate members do not own manufactured homes. They do not have voting rights and cannot hold office in GSMOL, but do receive The Californian magazine)

(DUES ARE NON-REFUNDABLE)

Comments (For Office Use)

First Name | Initial | Last Name

Spouse/Second Occupant

Park Name

Street Address | Space Number

City | State | Zip Code

Daytime Phone Number | Alternate Phone Number

Email Address

Signature | Membership Recruiter (if applicable)

- ☐ New Member
- ☐ Renewing Member

GSMOL Chapter # _____

Check # _____ / CASH

You can also contribute to any of the following GSMOL dedicated funds

Legal Defense Fund $____

Disaster Relief Fund $____

Political Action Committee (PAC) $____

FILL OUT AND RETURN THIS FORM ALONG WITH YOUR CHECK TO GSMOL, 14802 BEACH BLVD., LA MIRADA, CA 90638

DETACH AND KEEP FOR YOUR RECORDS Thank you!

Check#____ Amount____ Date____

GSMOL

Form 100
Rev 04/16

Please deposit membership dues in the GSMOL box located in the clubhouse.

Thank You!

VIEU NEWS

BY PETER CLEAVELAND

Can Carbon Capture Save Us?

About ten percent of Americans don't believe that climate change is happening, Of the 75% who agree that it's happening, 54% believe it's caused by human activity, while 14 percent believe it's a natural phenomenon.

But can we do anything to stop it? Governments around the world are trying to reduce the emission of the greenhouse gases — mostly carbon dioxide (CO2) — that cause it, but to really make a difference would have such severe economic consequences that it's probably politically impossible. There is also well-organized and well-financed opposition.

And this doesn't account for the fact that increasing global temperatures are causing the frozen tundra from Alaska to Canada to Siberia to thaw, releasing huge amounts of methane, which is 25 times as effective a greenhouse gas as (CO2). There's nothing we can do to stop that.

If we can't stop the greenhouse gases from getting into the atmosphere, is there a way to remove them? That's called Carbon Capture and Storage (CSS), and there is lots of experimentation going on to make it work. The idea is to somehow collect the CO2 — either at its source, for example power plants that burn coal, oil or natural gas, or cement plants that create huge amounts of CO2 — or straight out of the air, and then pump it into the earth where it is supposed to remain for all time.

Does it work? Yes, sort of. Can we do enough of it to make a difference? Not sure. Can we afford it? That's a matter of opinion, but if things get bad enough we may have no choice but to pay whatever it costs. The alternative is too horrible to contemplate.

碳捕获能拯救我们吗？

大约有 10% 的美国人不相信气候变化正在发生。在 75% 同意气候变化存在的人群中，54% 认为这是由人类活动引起的，而 14% 认为这是一种自然现象。

但我们能做些什么来阻止它吗？全球各国政府正试图减少导致气候变化的温室气体排放，主要是二氧化碳 (CO2)。然而，要真正产生显著影响，将带来严重的经济后果，这在政治上几乎是不可能的。此外，减排行动还面临着组织严密、资金充足的反对力量。

更糟糕的是，随着全球气温上升，从阿拉斯加到加拿大再到西伯利亚的冻土层正在融化，释放出大量甲烷。甲烷的温室效应是二氧化碳的 25 倍，而对此我们无能为力。

如果我们无法阻止温室气体进入大气层，那么是否有办法将其移除呢？这就是所谓的碳捕获与封存 (CCS)，目前许多实验正在进行中，旨在使其奏效。其原理是在源头捕获 CO2，例如燃烧煤炭、石油或天然气的发电厂，或产生大量 CO2 的水泥厂；或者直接从空气中提取 CO2。随后，将这些二氧化碳泵入地下，理论上它们将永远留在那里。

这项技术有效吗？在某种程度上，是的。但我们能大规模实施以产生实质性影响吗？尚不确定。我们是否负担得起？这见仁见智，但如果情况变得糟糕到极点，我们或许别无选择，只能支付不惜一切代价。否则，后果将不堪设想。

MEN & WOMEN'S CLUB

May, 2025

ANNOUNCEMENT

We hope you joined in on our
Cinco de Mayo celebration on May 3.
Such a fun evening! OLE!!!

On the afternoon of Saturday, June 7 a speaker from the San Leandro Historical Society will present a program and pictures about the origins of our region. Light refreshments will be served.

And don't miss out on the annual July 4 BBQ on Saturday, July 5! Come out and enjoy delicious food, games, music and the 50/25/25 raffle as well as a prize raffle. (Any items you wish to donate to our prize table will be greatly appreciated.)

- August—Ice Cream Social
- September - Asian Dinner

As always, watch your mailboxes for more details about these events.

See you at the clubhouse!!



MEMORIAL DAY IS ON MAY 26

Memorial Day, originally called Decoration Day, began in the years following the American Civil War as a way to honor those who died in service, evolving from decorating graves to a national day of remembrance and reflection.

Here's a more detailed look at the history of Memorial Day:

Origins in the Civil War:
The practice of decorating the graves of fallen soldiers with flowers emerged during and after the Civil War, with communities coming together to honor those lost in battle.

Decoration Day:
In 1868, General John A. Logan, the commander-in-chief of the Grand Army of the Republic (a Union veterans' organization), called for a national day of remembrance on May 30th, to be known as Decoration Day, for decorating the graves of Civil War soldiers.

Early Observances:
The first national observance of Decoration Day took place in 1868 at Arlington National Cemetery, where 5,000 people helped decorate the graves of Union and Confederate soldiers.

Shift to Memorial Day:
After World War I, the holiday came to be known as Memorial Day, as it expanded to honor those who died in all U.S. wars, not just the Civil War.
Waterloo, New York:

The U.S. federal government declared Waterloo, New York, the official birthplace

of Memorial Day for starting the tradition of Memorial Day services in 1866.

National Holiday Act of 1971:
In 1971, Congress passed the National Holiday Act, establishing Memorial Day as the last Monday in May, which also helped ensure a three-day weekend for federal holidays.

Modern Observance:
Today, Memorial Day is observed on the last Monday of May and is a day to remember and honor the men and women who have died in service to the nation.

Traditions:
Common traditions include visiting cemeteries or memorials, holding family gatherings, participating in parades, and the National Moment of Remembrance at 3 p.m. local time.
Not a "Happy" Holiday:
It is important to remember that Memorial Day is a day of remembrance and reflection, not a "happy" holiday, and it is not appropriate to wish someone a "Happy Memorial Day".



WORD SEARCH

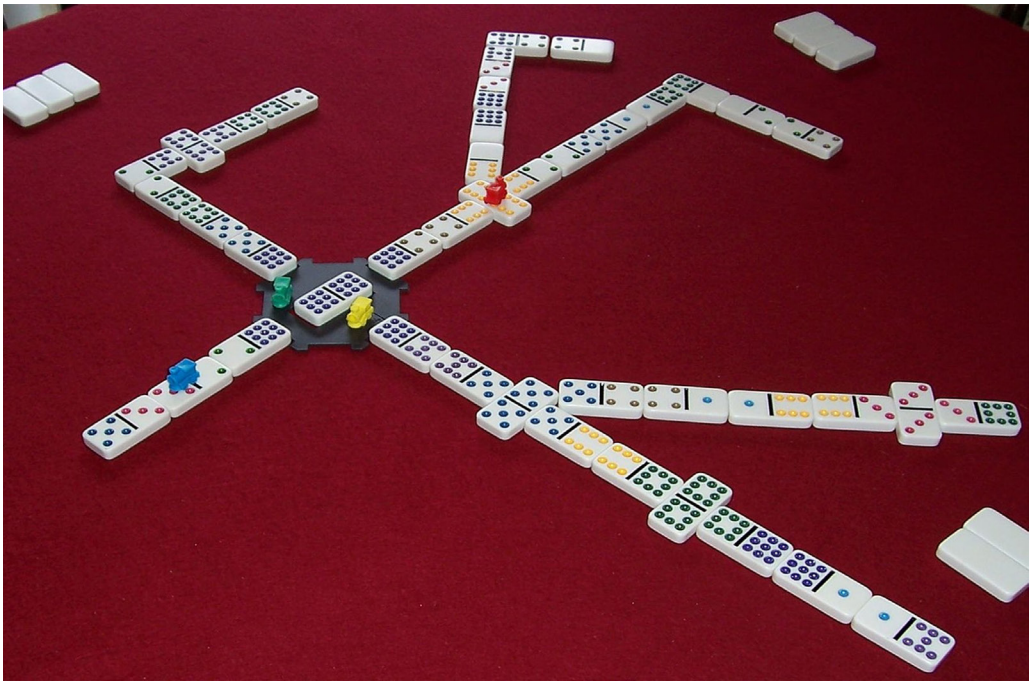
Happy Mother's day

S	E	O	P	U	E	M	R	R	E	E	I	I	U
M	L	U	F	M	O	M	P	I	U	V	L	H	M
G	B	C	D	I	G	O	O	T	H	I	O	E	Z
N	E	A	G	G	A	E	E	R	A	T	V	L	U
I	A	R	S	G	H	R	S	Z	R	R	I	P	P
R	U	I	P	N	F	L	T	L	D	O	N	F	D
O	T	N	Z	I	U	H	R	P	W	P	G	U	L
D	I	G	M	Z	N	U	O	O	O	P	F	L	T
A	F	R	O	A	N	G	N	I	R	U	D	N	E
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V	L	U	H	A	F	S	H	I	I	H	N	O	W
O	I	I	E	D	M	M	P	E	N	U	T	N	S
I	N	H	R	L	O	A	S	I	G	P	G	R	N
V	R	W	D	T	L	S	H	U	E	U	U	N	V

ENDURING
STRONG
HARDWORKING
MOM
BEAUTIFUL
AMAZING
LOVING
SUPPORTIVE
SWEET
MOTHER
FUN
CARING
ADORING
HELPFUL

What is Mexican Train Dominos?

By Pier Veit



Various historical articles suggest that the game originated with Chinese laborers, who brought their game of Pai Gow to Cuba in the 1850's when working in the sugar fields. Cubans already played dominoes, as it was known as the "National game of Cuba". The Chinese game also used tiles with numbers, and dates back to 960 A.D.

Cubans adapted this game , matching dominos with like numbers, Also they added a central Hub and a line of trains leaving the hub, and called it Domino Cubano.

In the 1890's, our railroads were being built with laborers from Mexico and Cuba, who brought the Cubano Domino to the U.S.. As Americans saw this game being played as the laborers toiled on the railroad tracks ,they began calling it Mexican Train dominoes.

Two Americans, Katie and Roy Parsons developed and copy righted rules for a game called Train in 1994. They sold the rights to Purenco, who marketed the game as Mexican Train, using a double 12 set with rules for 8 players.

Mexican Train has several differences from our early domino sets. . Firstly, there is a central HUB (or station) which has 8 spokes for players to build their private train. Secondly, there is the option (usually taken) for any player to start a public Mexican train, which is open for all to play on. This allows players another way to get rid of their stash of dominos (also called tiles). The goal of the game being, whoever gets rid of all their dominos first ends the game and wins that round. Thirdly, the dominoes have colored dots (or pips) to indicated the numbers. There are also tiles with numbers that can be used as well.

It is a game that requires observation of what dominoes have been played, and a little strategy on which of your dominoes to play.

‘It’s a shambles’: DOGE cuts bring chaos, long waits at Social Security for seniors

By Jenny Jarvie and Nathan Solis, Los Angeles Times



Elderly and disabled people are encountering severe service disruptions as the Trump administration overhauls the Social Security Administration system.

When Veronica Sanchez called a Social Security hotline Thursday, she waited two hours before her call was abruptly disconnected.

On Friday, she was on hold for six hours and still did not get through to anyone.

“I’m gonna have to take time out of my work to stand in line and hopefully get this resolved,” the 52-year-old medical practice manager in Canoga Park said Monday before calling one more time.

For Sanchez, the stakes are high: If she does not obtain a medical letter from the agency by April 15, her parents, who are on a fixed income, risk losing about $2,500 a month in medical care. They would no longer receive insulin medication for their diabetes, she said, and could lose their daily visit from a nurse.

But even if Sanchez shows up in person, she is not likely to speak to an agent. Field offices are no longer accepting walk-in appointments.

“The system, it’s broken down,” Sanchez said.

Elderly and disabled people — and those who care for them — are encountering a knot of bureaucratic hurdles and service disruptions after the Trump administration imposed a sweeping overhaul of the Social Security Administration system.

No field offices in California have closed. But there is rising frustration across

Southern California and the nation as many seniors experience crashed webpages, endure jammed phone lines and are turned away at offices. Social Security officials have downplayed the problems and said some of the issues predate the Trump administration and the government efficiency push headed by Elon Musk.

In February, the agency that sends monthly checks to nearly 73 million Americans announced plans to slash 7,000 jobs and consolidate its regional offices from 10 to four as part of an effort to "reduce the size of its bloated workforce and organizational structure." The cutbacks, enforced by Musk's advisory team known as the Department of Government Efficiency, represent a 12% reduction of the agency's workforce.

Sanchez does not believe she is reaping the benefits of government efficiency.

"It's frustrating," she said, noting that a call that would once take 15 minutes now involves much more work.

If Sanchez did not reach someone from Social Security this week, she worried her parents — particularly her mother, who suffers from rheumatoid arthritis so severe she struggles to hold a coffee cup — could end up in the hospital.

"If they don't have the caregiver that's coming by to monitor their sugar in the morning, do the blood pressure readings ..." she said, "I don't even want to think about the worst-case scenario. They will definitely be in a very, very, very bad situation." Last week, a coalition of advocacy groups, including the American Assn. of People with Disabilities, filed a federal lawsuit against the Social Security Administration, Acting Commissioner Leland Dudek, and Musk. It alleged that the agency overhaul "severely undermined" services and caused "significant and irreparable harm."

"In just nine weeks, the new administration has upended the agency with sweeping and destabilizing policy changes — shifting critical agency functions onto overburdened local offices, slashing telephone-based services, and debilitating the agency's ability to meet beneficiaries' needs," the lawsuit filed in the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia alleges.

"The result is a systematic dismantling of SSA's core functions, leaving millions of beneficiaries without the essential benefits they are legally entitled to," the lawsuit adds. "The defendants have abandoned their duty, placing ideology over obligation and governance over the governed."

Maria Town, president and chief executive of the American Assn. of People with Disabilities, told The Times that the system changes were not only hurting people's ability to sign up and enroll for benefits. People already connected to the system who needed support were also having trouble appealing benefits decisions or accessing medical services.

"You can't get anyone on the phone," she said.

Even before Trump took office, Town said, the system had challenges: About 30,000 disabled people died in 2023 waiting for their SSDI application to be approved.

"This is just going to make life harder for millions of Americans," she said. "Americans with disabilities want government to be efficient and responsible to the needs of people. These cuts, despite their claims, are actually counter to that goal."

The Social Security Administration did not respond to The Times' requests for comment on the problems elderly and disabled people reported accessing services. The agency's press office acknowledged in a string of posts on X that telephone wait times were too long and its website had faced challenges, but said the issues "predate the current Administration."

"Zero customer-facing representatives been let go," the agency said, noting that it continued to "move employees from non-mission critical positions to bolster the ranks of our existing, dedicated frontline employees to serve the public."

The restructuring was "focused on mission-critical services without compromising service quality," the agency said, and "aligns with the American people's call for efficiency in government operations."

But across Los Angeles, people who showed up at Social Security field offices without appointments were turned away.

Andrew Taylor, 55, threw his hands up in the air Monday morning as he walked out of the Social Security office on Wilshire Boulevard.

"Everything is by appointment now," a federal employee told a small group of people lined up on the sidewalk.

Taylor, who is homeless and lives on Skid Row, had lined up just before the doors opened at 9 a.m. He wanted to get an award letter that would allow him to apply for food stamps and other benefits, but he was told he would have to wait three hours to get in. Even if he did, there was no guarantee that he would get the letter at the office.

“It’s ridiculous,” Taylor said. “They said they would have to mail it to me and there’s nothing they could do for me today.”

About five months ago, Taylor said, he asked for the same letter at the same office and did not run into any issues. He didn’t know what to make of the difference and had not followed the changes in the White House.

“If this is what they’re doing in Washington, it isn’t fair to everyone else,” he said. “Poor people always seem to get the worst of it.”

Several other people waited in line, including Camilla Sosa, 68, who said she waited on hold over the phone for about two hours on Friday. She had not received a letter from Social Security that she needs to allow her to open a new bank account, and she wasn’t able to get a straight answer about why.

An agency employee told her that without an appointment, she would have to wait for three hours.

“Oh no, that’s so long,” she said in Spanish. She decided to leave and try again another day.

Social Security employees handed out a flier with a phone number and a QR code that people could scan with their phones to make an appointment. But the website kept returning an error message.

Advocates for seniors say challenges accessing Social Security help were compounded in March when the Trump administration announced new online verification procedures that resulted in many elderly and disabled Americans being unable to use their personal “my Social Security” account.

“The system is a shambles,” said Gevorg Adjian, the founder of All Seniors Foundation, a nonprofit organization in Los Angeles that offers free medical care, supplies, and healthcare services for seniors.

After sending out a letter last month urging people having trouble with the online system to come on in, Adjian said, the administration then eliminated any kind of walk-in appointments.

Adjian said he had fielded calls from seniors who had lost or not received checks.

“They have no one to reach out to to find out the status of it, and appointments are three, four or five months down the line,” Adjian said. “On a Social Security income, you can’t really wait three, four months and not have any payments.”

Adjian said his foundation helps seniors get the online logins that they need. But uploading their ID could be a challenge, he said, because most of them don’t use smart devices or have emails.

“It’s cut out the seniors from communicating with the Social Security office,” he said of the system overhaul.

Adding to the complication, the agency was cutting out paper checks, which many elderly people who do not trust online transactions rely on.

Dr. Stephen Carney, 74, an emergency care physician in Los Angeles who receives Social Security, said he expected the changes to hurt a lot of elderly people who are not computer savvy.

“Everyone agrees there’s excess and waste in government in any nation,” he said. “But you don’t take a meat cleaver and do surgery.”

At a Los Angeles Social Security office on Crenshaw Boulevard, security guards did not allow anyone inside the building Monday without an appointment.

A woman leaning on a walker approached the doors after getting out of her Uber. She said she had an appointment.

The security guard looked at her paperwork and said her appointment was for a phone call and someone from the agency was scheduled to call her.

She laughed loudly and said, “Just let me in.”

The guard directed her to a phone number on a flier posted on the door and said she could try to get more information from the number.

“We don’t have anything for you here right now,” the guard said.

Her caretaker directed her back into the parking lot to call for another rideshare driver.



As food insecurity and hunger rates rise, SNAP benefits are going unused

16 Million Older Americans are Not Claiming Their Food Benefits, AARP Reports

Nearly 60 percent of low-income older adults who qualify for federal food assistance aren't using it, according to a new analysis by AARP's Public Policy Institute. Some 16 million — or 59 percent — of adults 50-plus who could get help paying for food through the U.S. Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) in 2022 did not claim it.

"Millions of older adults are missing out on benefits that could have a big impact on their livelihood," says AARP's Olivia Dean, senior policy advisor and co-author of the report published March 28.

Roughly 1 in 10 older adults are food insecure, meaning they have limited access to adequate, nutritious food due to financial constraints. Research links food insecurity to poorer health outcomes, including higher rates of diabetes, high blood pressure, congestive heart failure, asthma, gum disease, depression and other illnesses in adults 60 and older.

SNAP, which is federally funded but administered by states and sometimes counties, aims to reduce food insecurity and increase the purchase of nutritious foods by providing many low-income people and families with financial assistance.

But AARP's report found that most adults ages 50 and older who were eligible for SNAP in 2022 did not participate in the program, and people ages 60 and older participated at particularly low rates. While most older adults skipping their benefits would be eligible for just the minimum SNAP allowance of about $20 a month in 2022, one in five may be missing out on benefits of over $300 a month, the report found.

Meanwhile, food insecurity among older adults has been rising. In 2023, 10.4 percent of Americans ages 50 and older, or 12.6 million, were food insecure, according to AARP Public Policy Institute's analysis of Current Population Survey data. The rate jumped from 9.8 percent in 2022 and 7.9 percent in 2021 and represents the highest rate in nearly a decade.

Removing barriers that may prevent those 16 million older adults from enrolling in SNAP —

“These findings point to the need for targeted education and outreach about the program, as well as efforts at the federal and state levels to make it easier for older adults to access SNAP,” she says.

60-plus adults dominate group missing out

AARP’s analysis set out to better understand which older adults were eligible for SNAP but not enrolled and what benefits they’re not receiving, says AARP’s Dean. “Understanding their characteristics is important for addressing the low program enrollment,” she says.

The report uses state-specific SNAP eligibility rules to determine who qualified, rather than just federal eligibility standards, to provide a more accurate picture of the total number of people eligible for the program, Dean says. AARP partnered with research group Mathematica to do the analysis.

People ages 60 and older participated in SNAP at particularly low rates in 2022, the research found. Of the 16 million people identified who were not claiming their allowances, most — 14 million — were ages 60 and older. Only 1.9 million were ages 50 to 59.

Older adults who didn’t claim their benefits were more likely to live in a multi-person, higher-income (though still overall low-income) household compared to the older adults who did claim in 2022, the report found. Fifty-five percent of the 16 million nonparticipants were eligible for the minimum benefit of $20 a month in 2022.

Having just $20 loaded onto their SNAP benefits card each month may be a key reason why older adults don’t enroll in program, particularly when the process to get that $20 can be time-consuming and condescending, which many older adults report. “The average meal cost in the United States was estimated to be $3.99 in 2022, so the minimum monthly SNAP benefit would have covered just five individual meals,” our report explains.

“SNAP benefits should be meaningful,” the co-authors wrote. “Policymakers should continually work to ensure the adequacy of benefit allotments, including minimum and maximum amounts, which could improve access to SNAP for older adults and improve food security.”

While most of those older adults who didn’t claim their benefits were only eligible for the minimum benefit amount, we also found that 3.3 million of those not claiming — a “sizable minority” — were likely in households eligible for much more support: more than $300 per month.
“The fact that one-fifth of older nonparticipants are missing out on substantial benefits could mean that some are unaware of the benefit level they could receive and/or face barriers to applying, such as concerns that they will face a burdensome application process,” the report states.

Outreach efforts should be targeted at all eligible older nonparticipants, but the most effective outreach may be directed at those with the lowest incomes. “They might be more motivated than people with higher incomes to participate in the program, and enrolling could make a significant difference in their health and economic well-being,” the report suggests.
AARP is advocating to protect SNAP

AARP’s analysis comes at a critical time, with SNAP funding under threat amid federal budget negotiations in Congress. Lawmakers have not announced specific funding cuts to SNAP, but budget committees are searching for ways to help offset the cost of the Trump Administration’s proposed tax cuts.

On March 6, we sent letters to the U.S. Senate Committee on Agriculture, Nutrition & Forestry and the U.S. House Committee on Agriculture emphasizing the program's importance for older adults. We pointed to research showing that SNAP participation is linked to reduced healthcare costs, hospital and emergency room visits, and nursing home admissions.

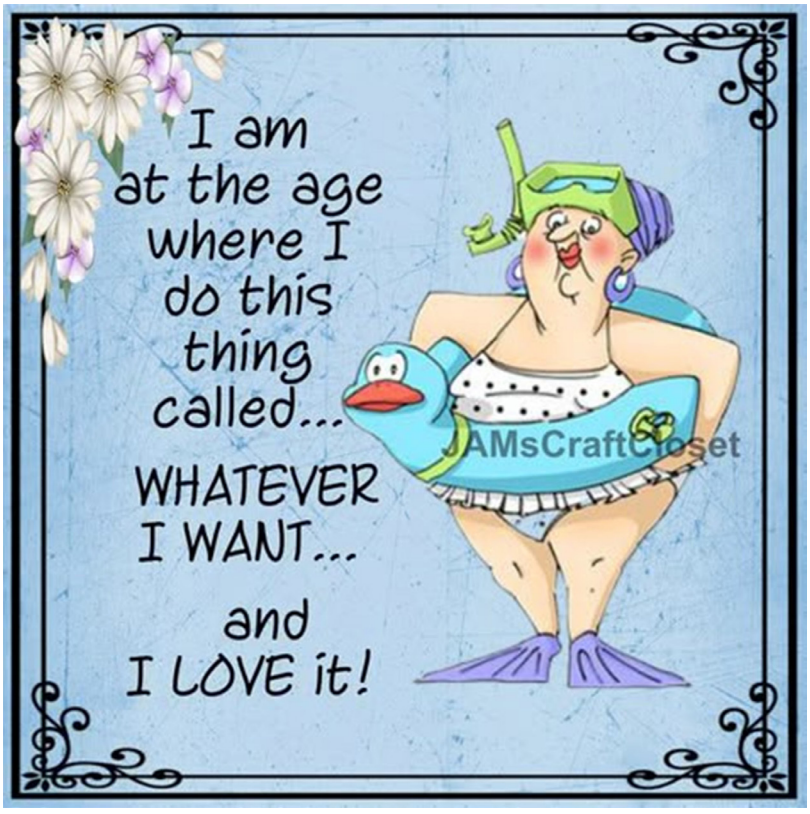
“The program provides modest support to help meet basic nutritional needs, which in turn can support improved health outcomes and help people maintain independence as they age,” wrote Bill Sweeney, AARP senior vice president for government affairs. “In short, SNAP is a sound investment.”

AARP’s report “emphasizes that there are already barriers to accessing SNAP and it’s important to be working to reduce those barriers rather than making it harder for people to access the program,” Dean says. Unofficial proposals swirling, such as eliminating broad-based categorical eligibility in SNAP, could make it harder to access the program.

S	E	O	P	U	E	M	R	R	E	E	I	I	U
M	L	U	F	M	O	M	P	I	U	V	L	H	M
G	B	C	D	I	G	O	O	T	H	I	O	E	Z
N	E	A	G	G	A	E	E	R	A	T	V	L	U
I	A	R	S	G	H	R	S	Z	R	R	I	P	P
R	U	I	P	N	F	L	T	L	D	O	N	F	D
O	T	N	Z	I	U	H	R	P	W	P	G	U	L
D	I	G	M	Z	N	U	O	O	O	P	F	L	T
A	F	R	O	A	N	G	N	I	R	U	D	N	E
O	U	L	T	M	O	F	G	H	K	S	A	E	E
V	L	U	H	A	F	S	H	I	I	H	N	O	W
O	I	I	E	D	M	M	P	E	N	U	T	N	S
I	N	H	R	L	O	A	S	I	G	P	G	R	N
V	R	W	D	T	L	S	H	U	E	U	U	N	V



Laughter is the Best Medicine



COMMUNITY BULLETIN

NEW MEXICAN TRAIN DOMINO GAME

Come check out the new and exciting game of Mexican Train Domino! It's a game that's good for brain health, helps with problem solving and improve memory while having fun with your fellow players! First meeting is on Wed. Jan 8 at 1:30. Refer to the Activity Calendar for the meeting dates.

PINOCLE FUN

Looking for players who enjoy strategic trick-taking card games. Contact Patty at 650 787-6080 and join the fun.

ELDER CARE

If you are a senior looking for assistance with grocery shopping, caregiving, need a ride to appointments, errands, picking up medications, run to the post office, light housekeeping or other tasks, please contact Michael at 510-604-5646. I live in Mission Bay.



SEEKING CHINESE TRANSLATOR

The VIEU is seeking a new Chinese translator to assist with communicating with our Chinese residents by translating monthly safety updates and articles. Please contact Pete Cleaveland at 510-351-1742.

POKER PLAYERS NEEDED

Wednesdays 12 - 3:30 at the Mission Bay Clubhouse



Anyone with old, torn, or faded American flag, may drop them off at 239 Santa Susana for proper disposal.

Senior Resource Guide and Important Phone Numbers

Alameda County Adult Protective Services	1 (866) 225-5277
Alameda County Crisis Support Services (24hr)	1 (800) 309-2131
Alameda County In-Home Supportive Services	1 (510) 577-1900
Alameda County Area Agency on Aging	1 (510) 577-3530
Alzheimer's Services of the East Bay	1 (510) 644-8292
American Diabetes Association	1 (510) 654-4499
Arthritis Foundation	1 (888) 391-9389
CA Dept. of Aging	1 (800) 510-2020
California Relay for Hearing Impaired	7-1-1
California Smoker's Helpline	1 (800) 662-8887
Center for Independent Living	1 (510) 841-4776
City of San Leandro Minor Home Repair	1 (510) 625-0316 x102
Consumer Fraud Reporting	1 (415) 553-7400
Covered California Hotline	1 (800) 300-1506
Davis Street Family Resource Center	1 (510) 347-4620
DMV	1 (800) 777-0133
ECHO Housing	1 (510) 581-9380
Emergency Services (Ambulance, Fire and Police)	9-1-1
Family Caregiver Alliance	1 (800) 445-8106
Flex Rides - City of San Leandro	1 (510) 577-7985
Health Insurance Counseling & Advocacy	1 (510) 839-0393
Legal Assistance for Seniors	1 (510) 832-3040
LIFE ElderCare	1 (510) 894-0370
Medi-Cal	1 (510) 670-6000
Mercy Brown Bag Program	1 (510) 534-8540 x369
Mobilehome Assistance Center (Complaints) HCD	(800) 952-8356
Mobilehome Residency Law Protection Program HCD	(800) 952-8356
Ombudsman Program	1 (510) 638-6878
PG&E Smarter Energy Line	1 (800) 933-9555
Paratransit – East Bay Paratransit (AC Transit)	1 (510) 287-5000
San Leandro Adult School	1 (510) 667-6287
San Leandro Marina Community Center	1 (510) 577-3462
San Leandro Senior Community Center	1(510) 577-3462
Senior Legal Hotline of Northern California	1 (800) 222-1753
Social Security Administration	1 (800) 772-1213
S.O.S./Meals on Wheels	1 (510) 582-1263
Spectrum Community Services, Inc.	1 (510) 881-0300
Spectrum Lunch Reservations - San Leandro SCC	1 (510) 825-9793
Supplemental Security Income (SSI)	1 (800) 772-1213
Sutter Care at Home	1 (800) 698-1273
The Friendship Line (Institute on Aging)	1 (800) 971-0016
Traffic and Transit	5-1-1
Veterans Assistance Benefits	1 (800) 827-1000
Well Connected	1 (877) 797-7299
Well Connected en Espaňol	1 (877) 400-5867